

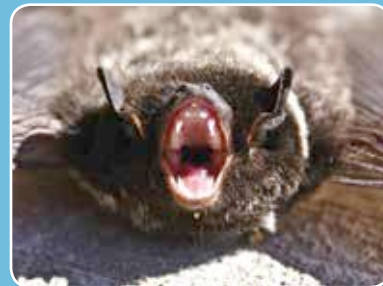


There are always those days when you sit and curse the creator (or whatever else you believe in) for giving you such a bad day. Take heart from these unlucky souls who've survived and struggled through a most improbable streak of bad luck.



A man who fell off a horse and then got run over by a delivery man, a man who fell off a tree, broke his arm and then broke it again when returning from hospital on Friday the 13th, a man who later fell down a manhole and broke his leg and injured both knees. Calling such a man unlucky is an understatement. But he's still smiling, and that's admirable.

...the same place twice. Or so you're taught as a child. But what about the same person? When a bolt of lightning strikes you, your body experiences temperatures in excess of 50,000°C, loss of consciousness and capillaries under your skin rupture. Now imagine facing that very same bolt but seven times. You'd have to be Roy Sullivan to be that unlucky.



1967: Fell overboard from the deck of a ship, picked up an hour later; 1971: struck by lightning and suffers nerve damage; 1973: struck by lightning again; 1981: strangled by husband. Jeanne Rogers might already be considered unlucky, but then she was later mugged, had a bat rip her hair out and “accidentally” pulled off a celebrity’s shorts. Whew! What a life!



What if everyone you knew suddenly became a millionaire? What if you found out that you aren't a millionaire because you were accidentally ignored? Well, that's what happened to Costis Mitsotakis, a Greek filmmaker who was somehow missed when the lottery tickets were being passed out. Tickets that won everyone in his village \$950 million.

When the ship you're on sinks, you're unlucky. When the next ship you're on sinks, you're twice as unlucky. When the ship after that sinks, you're just plain bad news. When one of those ships is the Titanic, the other the largest civilian liner of it's time and the last one a hospital ship, you're either Violet Jessop or among the unluckiest people alive.



If you believe that winning a \$16million lottery will give you peace and happiness, you'd be utterly wrong. William Post won \$16million, paid a third to a girlfriend who sued him, loaned some of the money to a brother who never returned it, spent some time in jail for firing a shotgun at a collection agent and died with a \$1million debt while surviving on food stamps.